THE ENEMY WITHIN - Family Betrayal, Community Power, Institutional Exile, and the Price of Integrity

A First-Person Documentary Testimony Concerning Thirty-Five Years of Family Loyalty, Sexuality-Based Shame, Unequal Treatment, Financial Hardship, Social Isolation, and the Faith That Kept Me Alive

***An account of personal recollection, family relationships, social power, financial dependence, institutional experiences, and the search for truth*.**

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My Testimony: I Am Still Here

Every day I exist is an existential threat to my panicking enemies, because I was not expected to survive and exist from the ashes of total human betrayal, social erasure and civil death: political exile, excommunication, total isolation, poverty, homelessness, administrative annihilation, intimate-partner betrayal and blood-family betrayal.

I am living in political exile from this so-called democracy, seeking asylum from what I believe is absolute, systemic, embedded corruption. Every professional, institution and service that pretended not to see my harm, feigned ignorance and innocence, or looked the other way while my humanity was discarded must confront the fact that I have documented my experience using the government's own official documentation, on its own letterheads and in its own words. I have preserved the evidence of what I experienced, including what I believe demonstrates the guilty blood on their hands.

I have timestamped my testimony on the digital blockchain. My testimony has escaped containment and erasure. It exists beyond the control of any single government agency, public official, politician, bank, NGO, university, radio or television broadcaster, police or law-enforcement body, media organisation, legal fraternity, ombudsman, court, tribunal, criminal organisation, intelligence service, the mega-rich or AI crawler. No institution's refusal to acknowledge my existence can make the documented record cease to exist.

God's favour is upon my life because humanity betrayed me and discarded me without morality or consciousness. I would rather have God and my dog, and nothing and no one else, without human or legal rights or pathways to justice through human-made systems, than have even a few people who feign care while deceiving me and be without my faith.

I have no malice and no intention to harm anyone. I have acted with honesty, documented facts and the courage to publish my testimony. Yet I believe individuals and institutions have contributed to my harm by accepting, enabling, neglecting or refusing to acknowledge my experiences of abuse, neglect, targeting, persecution, political exile and what I describe as literal torture, while looking the other way. What is presented as bureaucratic oversight, neutrality or non-action does not remove the human consequences. Where people knowingly permit harm to continue, I regard that as complicity and social mobbing, not innocence established merely by silence.

For 35 years, I offered every person and place grace, patience and divine mercy: the opportunity to treat me right. That gift of grace was, in my faith, the grace of the Most High placed within me. I believe that gift was spat upon, rejected and desecrated in every way, repeatedly, over those 35 years. To me, that was spiritual treason and an insult against the God who created the universe, chose me and placed His favour, protection, anointing and purpose upon my life.

I am not revengeful. I do not intend harm. Revenge is God's and God's alone. No one has the right to remove, damage, destroy or desecrate another human being from existence, or to harm or kill them, feign ignorance and then claim morality with shamelessness and impunity, particularly where they have responsibilities for that person's care.

Everyone slept peacefully at night in their beds and houses while my dog Crystal and I begged for our humanity in cars without a home, in squats and on the streets. People continued sleeping in comfort, luxury and privilege while we were without a home, without security and without the peace and happiness that others took for granted. I experienced a world in which our welfare appeared to be an afterthought, while those with the power to help continued with their lives. I believe God sees what humanity refused to see, and God is furious.

Humanity would never have survived if the principle were accepted that a vulnerable, disabled person who had never harmed anyone could be targeted and erased without consequence. I understand my experience as that of a gay, disabled, unprotected whistleblower who believes he has been subjected to a state-sanctioned campaign of targeting and attempted erasure. I describe the sacrifice demanded of me as human sacrifice: the destruction of the life of an individual who had the sovereign courage to speak about corruption, regardless of the personal consequences, with courage, integrity, documented facts and faith.

I believe this is why God chose Barran: not because I am entitled to harm anyone, but because my life and testimony have a purpose beyond the institutions and individuals that I believe betrayed me. I believe I was given a purpose in God at this time in history,

and that the betrayal and exile through which I have been forged were not God's punishment, but the circumstances through which His protection over my life and His purpose for my testimony became central to my survival.

God picked me up when I was broken. God sustained my life when I had been discarded by humanity. I believe I survived so that I could document the evidence, preserve the government's own records, publish my testimony and bear witness to what I believe must be exposed. I understand myself as God's chosen witness, called to confront darkness, expose corruption and dismantle the conditions that permit it to continue, for His Kingdom purposes.

I refused to die like they wanted. I refused my own erasure after total human betrayal, without a single person being held accountable or having the courage to speak the truth about what their intentions were, as they slept guilt-free without a care.

It was not just that they ignored me or forgot about me. I believe the documented history of my experience demands examination of whether people gathered in groups, coordinated their actions and contributed to my demise. I experienced what I believe was the celebration of my anticipated destruction, as though there were zero possibilities left for my healing, happiness or literal survival. When I suffered, I felt abandoned and humiliated. I believe people knew I was hurting and desperate, yet the harm continued, with what I experienced as people ganging up on me and then punishing me with impunity.

And without even pointing it out, my simple existence now embodies God's divine reckoning, shining a bright light on what I believe are their cowardly, guilty consciences. I want to know why not a single person has the courage to look me in the eye and honestly account for what happened. I believe my survival and rise expose the failures that those responsible would rather leave unexamined.

With God on my side, they underestimated me. I am healed in whole. I am at peace. I am gifted, intelligent, and I have integrity, honesty and courage. I come armed with the evidence contained in their own agencies' records, on their own letterheads and in their own words.

The evidence is not necessarily obvious in every individual document viewed in isolation. Collectively, however, across more than 35 years, these records illustrate what I regard as the absurd apex of bureaucratic neutrality dressed up in policy, alongside failures that I believe warrant examination against the laws, obligations and codes of conduct those institutions were supposed to uphold.

Retrospectively, these records reek to high hell of the privileged public bureaucrat soaking in unearned privilege, comfort and favour, acting with an arrogant audacity that suggests impunity, as if bulletproof, as if I would never see past the veil of their lies or call out their cowardice in consigning a vulnerable, innocent person to oblivion — a person they were legally mandated and obliged to care for.

So I dare any one of them: look me in the eye. Come to my accommodation, where I live in poverty and where I report experiencing abuse, neglect and what I describe as torture. Look at the evidence. Read your own correspondence. Explain your own decisions.

What did you mean by that letter you wrote me from your cushy government chair?

I am still here. I refused to die. I refused my own erasure. I refused to let their silence become the final account of my existence.

My existence is my refusal to be erased. My testimony is preserved. My faith remains. My purpose is to expose the truth, and I leave revenge and ultimate judgment to God.

Praise Jesus.

I am at peace. Sane. Content. Existing. God has my back. And no one wins a fight against existence itself.

My allegiance is with God: eternal, loving, divine and everlasting. Not some corrupt bureaucracy which, in comparison with God's eternity, is fleeting, cruel, corrupt and cold — the antithesis of God's grace.

No matter what they remove or take from me without a second thought, I have survived, not because they helped me, but in spite of what I believe was the evil through which they aimed to erase me from existence. I have an anointing of favour, and I embody a truth they cannot bear.

They cannot even look me in the eye with the courage of their convictions, with the ethics, morality or humanity to acknowledge what I have documented. I held up a divine mirror of truth, and they are too ashamed to acknowledge their own reflection or own their darkness. Instead of healing, taking responsibility or asking forgiveness, they double down and smash the mirror.

I have what they lack. I have faith. I have a conscience. I have survived. I have the documented record, and I have a purpose that does not depend on their permission,

recognition or approval.

They may take material things, deny me access, remove opportunities, abandon their responsibilities or refuse to acknowledge my existence, but they cannot remove my faith in the Divine, nor can they determine the purpose I believe God has placed upon my life and calling.

I am still here. I am still existing. I am still bearing witness.

God has my back. My allegiance is with the eternal, loving, everlasting Divine, and no bureaucracy, institution, individual or human-made system can take that relationship from me.

I am at peace. Sane. Content. Existing.

My truth is fact-checked, evidence-based, published and preserved by the Most High God. Where is your proof?

I never needed you, your money, or your bribes or temptations to comfort and complicity. I survived in spite of you all, with God's divine favour and grace. My conscience is clean. I gave you grace to treat me right — and you laughed.

Now look me in the fucking eye, with proof, with the courage of your convictions, and with a clean conscience — and tell me again what you meant by that letter.

Praise Jesus.

PART ONE — THE FAMILY, THE COMMUNITY, AND THE ORIGINS OF EXILE

1. The Story That Must Be Told in Full

My story cannot be understood by examining individual incidents in isolation. To understand what happened to me, readers need to understand the family into which I was born, the people who held social and financial influence, the expectations of loyalty and masculinity that surrounded me, and the difference between the public reputations of my relatives and the private experiences I remember.

I have spent years trying to understand how I came to experience such profound isolation from my family and community, particularly during periods when I was vulnerable, financially insecure, homeless, or trying to obtain assistance after injury.

I have questioned why the people who appeared to possess resources, influence, professional relationships, and community standing did not provide the kind of practical support I believed was available to them when I needed it.

I have questioned why my isolation was sometimes treated as a personal failing rather than a circumstance deserving compassion and investigation.

I have questioned why I felt that my sexuality was a source of shame, why experiences from my youth continued to affect my understanding of myself, and why I struggled to obtain a hearing when I attempted to explain what I had experienced.

I have also questioned the relationship between family loyalty and silence. I was taught that family mattered, that relatives were meant to stand together, and that loyalty was an important virtue. For a long time, I held on to those beliefs and continued to hope that my parents and extended family would eventually understand my circumstances.

Over time, I began to question whether my understanding of loyalty had left me vulnerable to accepting treatment that I should have challenged much earlier.

This document records that process of reflection.

It is not written on the assumption that every relative shared the same motives, that every disagreement was coordinated, or that every suspicion I have formed is necessarily correct. It is written because my recollections deserve to be recorded in their full context, because the relevant documentary evidence should be open to examination, and because the distinction between a person's public standing and another person's private experience can be significant.

My purpose is to preserve the history as I remember it, identify the questions that remain unresolved, and invite examination of the evidence rather than allowing my account to be reduced to a convenient characterisation of me.

I want readers to understand the circumstances in which my sense of belonging deteriorated, the relationships I came to distrust, and the reasons I believe family, community reputation, financial power, and institutional responses must be examined together.

2. Snowy McLean: A Popular Grandfather and the Family Culture I Came to Question

My grandfather, Snowy McLean, occupies an important place in my understanding of the

family culture in which I grew up.

As I remember him, Grandpa was a popular, clever, cheeky, and mischievous man. He had personality. He was socially recognised, and he knew how to occupy a place within the world around him. He could be entertaining and memorable, and his reputation was part of the family history that surrounded me.

I also understand that he was a member of the Freemasons and held a senior Masonic title that I remember as "Grand Puja." I want that title to be checked against reliable historical or organisational records before it is represented as the precise formal title he held.

At the time, I did not understand the significance that his membership, social relationships, and standing might have had within the wider culture of our family and community. I was a younger person, and I did not have the knowledge or perspective to examine those things critically.

I have since become concerned about what I perceive as the capacity of closed social networks to reinforce loyalty, protect reputations, discourage dissent, and make it difficult for people who do not conform to prevailing expectations to be accepted.

I have also come to associate aspects of the culture I experienced with rigid expectations of masculinity, hostility towards homosexuality, and an emphasis on loyalty that can become harmful when it is used to discourage a person from speaking about mistreatment.

My personal spiritual interpretation of these experiences has become strong. I have sometimes described what I perceive as the darker or corrupt aspects of that culture in terms of spiritual corruption, including language about satanic influence. That is my religious and moral interpretation of the experiences I have described; I do not have evidence establishing that Freemasonry as a whole is satanic, or that every member shares the attitudes I experienced.

My concern is not to substitute a label for evidence. It is to explain why I have come to question the values, conduct, and social expectations that shaped my experience of family life.

One memory, in particular, has stayed with me.

Grandpa used to call me a "poofter."

That word was not neutral in the environment in which I grew up. It was a derogatory term directed at perceived homosexuality or a failure to conform to conventional masculine expectations. At a time when I was not confident about my sexuality, being called that by a grandfather whose approval and acceptance mattered to me was painful.

Nana was upset when he called me that. She would ask him not to do it.

Her reaction is important to my account. It demonstrates that the language was not necessarily accepted by everyone in the family and that someone close to me recognised its hurtful character. Nana's objections stand out in my memory because she was trying to stop a form of treatment that caused me distress.

I remember that distinction.

Grandpa could use the word, but Nana recognised that it was wrong to continue using it against me.

I cannot establish precisely what Grandpa intended each time he said it. He may have understood it as teasing, or he may have held attitudes about homosexuality that I can no longer independently determine. What I can describe is how I remember the words and the effect they had on me.

I was growing up at a time when I was still trying to understand my sexuality and find confidence in myself. Instead of feeling entirely free to explore who I was, I became conscious that other people might interpret my behaviour through a derogatory label.

I began to wonder whether being different meant that I would be ridiculed, judged, or treated as someone whose dignity mattered less.

Looking back, I believe those experiences may have contributed to the atmosphere in which my sexuality was understood within the family. I also wonder whether the attitudes expressed by Grandpa influenced my father's perspective. I cannot prove the extent of that influence, and I do not claim to know every private conversation that occurred between them. But the possibility is important to my understanding of the family dynamics that followed.

A child's understanding of acceptance is shaped by repeated experiences. When a person hears a derogatory term used against them by a family member, and when that term relates to a part of themselves they are still struggling to understand, the experience can become more than a passing insult.

It can shape their expectations of other people's reactions.

It can make them reluctant to speak openly.

It can cause them to anticipate humiliation before it occurs.

And it can leave them uncertain whether the people who claim to love them will defend their dignity when it matters.

I believe this history deserves to be considered when examining my later experiences of sexuality-based shame, isolation, and conflict with people in positions of authority.

3. Nana's Objections and the Significance of One Person Speaking Up

Nana's response to Grandpa's language deserves to be recorded in its own right.

She was upset when he called me a "poofter," and she asked him not to.

That detail matters because it demonstrates that the treatment I remember was not something I have retrospectively invented simply because I later became unhappy with my family circumstances. It is a specific recollection of a repeated form of language and of another family member's objection to it.

Nana's reaction also reminds me that people within the same family can understand a situation differently. One person may dismiss hurtful language as humour, while another recognises the humiliation it can cause.

I do not know whether Nana fully understood the broader effect those words had on my developing confidence and sense of belonging. But I remember that she did not want Grandpa to continue calling me that.

Her objection gave me an indication that the language was not inevitable, necessary, or beyond criticism.

Someone could challenge it.

Someone could say that it should stop.

That is significant because much of my later experience involved trying to understand why conduct I found hurtful seemed to remain unacknowledged or unchallenged by

people whose support I wanted.

In my understanding, a healthy family should be able to recognise when teasing becomes humiliation, when loyalty becomes silence, and when a person's vulnerability calls for protection rather than ridicule.

I wanted that kind of protection. I wanted to be accepted without having to prove that I was sufficiently masculine, sufficiently successful, or sufficiently convenient to other people's reputations.

I wanted to be able to grow into adulthood without feeling that my sexuality made me a target.

Nana's objection remains one of the memories through which I understand that a different response was possible.

4. My Father: Fifty Years of Baseball, Community Recognition, and Social Standing

My father held an important place in the local community through baseball.

As I remember it, he was a popular and proud member of the local baseball club. He devoted approximately fifty years to baseball and to the club, and I understand that the club was named after him while he was still alive.

That was a substantial public legacy.

Dad was not simply someone who occasionally participated in a recreational activity. Baseball was a major part of his life and public identity. His long involvement meant that he was known by many people, and he had relationships extending beyond the immediate circle of players.

In a community connected through sport, employment, business, and local institutions, a long-serving club member can become familiar to people across many parts of society.

I understood Dad to be someone who knew just about everyone around him.

His circle may have included lawyers, police officers, firefighters, tradespeople, business owners, other sporting figures, and people who were socially connected through their work and community involvement. I cannot independently establish the precise extent of every relationship or what any particular person knew about my

private life. But my understanding was that Dad had a substantial network of acquaintances and longstanding community relationships.

His public standing matters to my story because it forms part of the contrast I experienced between his place in the community and my own.

Dad was a recognised person. His contribution to baseball was known and celebrated. He had a community identity built over decades.

I did not feel that I had an equivalent place.

I remember spending substantial periods of my youth driving around in the car, often alone. Rather than feeling securely connected to family and community, I experienced significant isolation. I was still trying to understand myself and work out where I belonged.

I remember Dad sometimes saying words to the effect of:

"My mate saw the Volkswagen down South Road. What were you doing down there? Off on your own again?"

I remember the effect of those comments. I felt that I was being questioned or berated for being alone, as though my movements were something to criticise rather than a sign that I was isolated.

The question that has remained with me is why my being alone seemed to attract scrutiny without, in my experience, leading to a meaningful examination of why I was spending so much time alone in the first place.

I felt that I was being held responsible for my isolation.

But I did not experience that isolation as something I had simply chosen without cause. I felt excluded. I felt uncertain about my place in the family. I felt that I was trying to navigate a world in which my sexuality and identity could become subjects of judgement.

The contradiction was painful: my father could be celebrated for his contribution to the local community, while I felt that I was spending my youth outside the security of that same community.

I do not claim that Dad's popularity proves he used his influence against me. Nor do I

claim that being a respected member of a sporting club makes a person responsible for every action taken by other club members or community figures.

The significance is different.

His standing meant that he was socially embedded in a network from which I often felt disconnected. It made me conscious of the difference between being known and respected and feeling that one's own account might not receive the same recognition.

I wondered whether people who knew Dad would see events through the lens of his reputation. I wondered whether gossip about me would have a different meaning because of his position. I wondered whether the embarrassment I felt was connected to the prospect that private events might become known to people who had relationships with my family.

These questions became especially important in relation to the police incident I remember.

5. The Volkswagen, South Road, and the Contradiction of Being Questioned About Isolation

The memory of Dad referring to his mate seeing my Volkswagen on South Road has remained significant because of the way I experienced the exchange.

I remember being questioned about where I had been and why I was driving around alone. The comments conveyed to me that my movements were visible to people who knew my father and that those observations could be reported back to him.

The experience made me conscious that I was not moving through the community as an entirely anonymous young person. I felt that I could be recognised, discussed, and questioned through the social relationships surrounding my family.

That feeling was particularly uncomfortable because I was already struggling with isolation and uncertainty about my identity.

When Dad asked what I was doing down there or why I was "off on my own again," I felt that the focus was on my behaviour rather than my circumstances.

I wanted someone to ask why I was alone so often.

I wanted someone to consider whether I was feeling excluded or whether there were

reasons I did not feel comfortable within the family and community.

I wanted to be offered understanding rather than made to feel that my solitude was evidence of some personal defect.

I experienced the questioning as a form of contradiction. I felt that I was isolated by the circumstances of my family life, yet I was also criticised for being isolated.

I cannot establish that Dad intended to create this contradiction. He may have believed that he was asking ordinary parental questions or expressing concern. I am recording how I remember those conversations and why they became important in the way I later interpreted my relationship with him.

The distinction between intention and impact is essential.

I cannot read another person's mind. I can, however, describe the impact of a repeated interaction on my own understanding of myself.

The impact was that I felt watched but not understood.

I felt questioned but not necessarily supported.

I felt that people might know where I had been without knowing why I was there.

And I felt that the community in which my father was respected was not necessarily a community in which I could comfortably explain my own experience.

That is the context in which I remember the later police incident.

6. The Consensual Sexual Encounter and the Springvale Police Incident

One of the most consequential experiences in my recollection of my youth involved consensual sexual activity with a girl that I remember being interrupted by local police.

At the time, I was not confident about my sexuality. I was still trying to understand myself and determine how I could live without being humiliated or judged for aspects of my identity that I did not yet fully understand.

The incident became significant in my memory because it was connected to the possibility of exposure, community gossip, and sexuality-based shame.

I remember the encounter as consensual. I believe it is important to preserve that distinction rather than allow the fact that police became involved to determine how the event is automatically interpreted.

The exact circumstances, including what occurred, what the police observed, what was said, and how the matter was handled, should be assessed against any available contemporaneous records or independent evidence. My recollection is the starting point of this account, not a substitute for records that may still exist.

What I remember most clearly about the broader experience is the sense of vulnerability.

I was young and uncertain about my sexuality. I was conscious that other people might interpret my behaviour through a derogatory label. I already had memories of Grandpa calling me a "poofter" and Nana objecting. Those earlier experiences formed part of the emotional context in which I understood the possibility of being exposed or judged.

I came to believe that the shame directed at me was connected to sexuality rather than to a question of consent. In my understanding, the experience became entangled with the idea that I could be treated as dirty, embarrassing, or disgraceful because of how other people perceived me.

I cannot independently establish what every person involved believed. I cannot say, without evidence, that every officer shared the same attitude or that the entire Springvale Police Force acted according to a single intention.

But I can describe the question that has remained with me: was I being treated as a young person whose circumstances required fair and respectful handling, or was my sexuality becoming a source of humiliation?

That question matters because a person's experience of an encounter with authority can be shaped by more than the immediate event. It can also be shaped by fear, stigma, power imbalance, and the possibility that information will spread through a close-knit community.

I was particularly conscious of my father's social standing. He had spent decades involved in baseball and was widely known through the club. I believed he had relationships with people from many parts of the local community, potentially including people in professions such as law enforcement and the legal system.

That made the possibility of gossip especially confronting.

I worried about who might hear about the incident, how it might be described, and whether my private conduct would become a source of shame for me or embarrassment for my family.

I came to believe that I was being judged through a sexuality-based lens. I felt that the question was not simply what had happened, but what people thought it said about me.

I was not confident enough at that time to separate my own developing understanding of sexuality from the judgement I feared others might impose upon me.

That is why I remember the incident as more than a brief encounter with police. In my recollection, it became part of a wider experience of feeling exposed, isolated, and uncertain whether I could expect fairness from people who held authority.

7. My Father's Reputation and My Fear of Community Gossip

The significance of my father's baseball standing must be considered alongside the circumstances of the police incident.

Dad was a long-serving and respected member of a local sporting community. He had relationships that had developed over many years, and I understood him to be familiar with people across a broad range of occupations and social circles.

I believed that if a private incident involving me became the subject of local gossip, it might travel through those relationships.

I cannot establish that it did travel through a particular network, that any particular person discussed it, or that Dad used his standing to influence how anyone treated me. Those are questions that would require specific evidence.

But the possibility of gossip was significant to me at the time.

I was not a confident young man who felt secure in his identity. I was someone who remembered being called a derogatory name by a family member and who had seen Nana object to that treatment. I was conscious that sexuality could be used to ridicule or diminish me.

In that context, the prospect of a private sexual encounter becoming known to people connected to my father was frightening.

I feared that I would be shamed not because the encounter had been non-consensual, but because people might attach a negative meaning to my sexuality, my masculinity, or my perceived failure to conform to expectations.

I experienced this as an unequal social situation.

My father had an established public identity. He was known through decades of participation in baseball. I did not have the same standing, confidence, or ability to influence how other people might interpret events involving me.

I felt that I was vulnerable to being discussed while lacking the social position to answer that discussion on equal terms.

The contrast was not simply between a popular father and an isolated son. It was between two different levels of social security.

Dad had a recognised place in the community.

I was still trying to find a place where I could be accepted.

Dad's history in baseball was publicly associated with commitment and community service.

My private life, as I feared it might be interpreted, could become a source of embarrassment or ridicule.

Dad had longstanding relationships.

I felt that I was alone in trying to make sense of the event and its consequences.

I cannot prove that other people deliberately used this imbalance against me. But the imbalance forms an important part of how I remember the circumstances and why I believe they deserve examination.

8. The Question of Homophobia and the Burden of Family Reputation

Looking back, I believe that the language I heard from Grandpa, Nana's objection to it, my father's social standing, and the police incident belong in the same personal history.

That does not mean I can prove that they were parts of a coordinated plan. It means that they are connected in my recollection through a common theme: my fear that sexuality

could be used to diminish my standing within the family and community.

Grandpa's use of the word "poofter" communicated a derogatory judgement about perceived homosexuality. Nana's objections showed that someone in the family recognised the hurtfulness of that judgement. My father's public reputation made me conscious of the wider community in which private matters might be discussed. The police incident heightened my sense of exposure at a time when I was not confident in myself.

Taken together, these experiences contributed to my understanding of how shame can operate.

It does not always arrive as a formal accusation. Sometimes it appears in a joke, a nickname, a question about where someone has been, a dismissive remark, or the fear that a private event will become public knowledge.

A person who is already uncertain about their identity may begin to anticipate judgement even before it is expressed. They may become guarded, isolated, or reluctant to ask for help.

That is how I remember feeling.

I came to believe that I was being made to carry the burden of other people's expectations about sexuality and masculinity. I felt that the possibility of being perceived as gay or insufficiently masculine could be used to shame me, regardless of whether the actual conduct at issue justified any criticism.

I want this account to remain precise about what I can and cannot establish.

I can report the words I remember Grandpa using and Nana's objections. I can report my recollection of my father's comments about the Volkswagen and South Road. I can describe the consensual nature of the sexual encounter as I remember it and the police involvement that I recall. I can explain the fear of gossip and the significance I attached to my father's social standing.

I cannot infer from those memories alone the private thoughts of every person involved, the contents of conversations I did not hear, or the existence of a coordinated arrangement.

My testimony is stronger when those distinctions remain visible.

The point is not to diminish my experience. The point is to ensure that the experience can be examined seriously, without confusing the events I remember with conclusions that require further evidence.

9. Bruce: Wealth, Property, Influence, and the Family Patriarch

My uncle Bruce occupies another central place in this history.

As I understood it, Bruce was a wealthy man with significant property interests, a collection of vintage cars, and a mansion in Brighton. I understood him to have substantial financial resources and a prominent place within our extended family.

His position meant that he had the capacity to provide assistance that would have been difficult for many other relatives to offer.

I also understood that he had supported members of the extended family through employment, financial assistance, and other opportunities. From my perspective, his resources gave him considerable influence over the practical circumstances of people who relied on him or looked to him for help.

I came to see him as a patriarch within the family: someone whose resources and approval mattered, whose actions could affect the opportunities available to relatives, and whose position carried social weight.

I do not suggest that being wealthy or influential is inherently wrong. Nor do I suggest that providing employment or financial assistance necessarily creates improper control. My concern is how these relationships operated in the context of the circumstances I experienced.

The central contrast was between the resources I believed were available and the assistance I received when I was in severe hardship.

I begged Bruce for financial help because I wanted to escape circumstances I experienced as abusive, neglectful, entrapping, and impoverished. I wanted to regain independence and rebuild my life. I wanted to re-establish my NDIS business and recover the stability I had lost.

I was not simply asking for a luxury or an improvement to an otherwise comfortable life. I was asking for practical assistance at a time when I believed I was struggling to escape a situation that was damaging my wellbeing and undermining my ability to support myself.

I recall Bruce telling me that I should work harder and create wealth as he had done.

Those words stayed with me because I believed they failed to account for the circumstances in which I was trying to survive.

I had already worked. I had been involved in providing NDIS services. I believed that injury, financial hardship, and the difficulties I was experiencing had materially affected my capacity to rebuild. I did not believe that an instruction to work harder answered the problems I was describing.

I experienced the response as a failure to recognise the difference between someone who has accumulated resources and someone who is trying to recover from a period of serious vulnerability.

I wanted help that was responsive to my actual circumstances.

I wanted a chance to get back on my feet.

I wanted someone within my own family to take my situation seriously enough to consider what could be done.

Instead, I felt that my hardship was being treated as a problem of effort or personal responsibility, rather than as a situation that required a fuller understanding.

That experience became a defining part of my perception of Bruce and of the unequal distribution of support within the family.

10. Bruce, Steve Isanides, Paris, and the Questions I Was Left With

There is another recollection involving Bruce and my former fiancé, Steve Isanides, that became significant to my understanding of the relationships within the family.

I remember Bruce asking Steve to go to Paris and raising the question of whether Steve would bring me or leave me at home.

The precise wording and circumstances should be checked against any contemporaneous correspondence or other records that may exist. I am recording the substance of what I remember and the questions it raised for me.

I found the exchange troubling because of the implication I perceived in the question. I

wondered why the issue was framed in terms of whether Steve would take me or leave me behind. I questioned what Bruce's interest in that arrangement meant and whether there was a dimension to the relationship that I did not understand.

I also remember a story my mother told involving Bruce, a G-string, and a maid's outfit. I include that recollection because it forms part of the context through which I later interpreted aspects of Bruce's private conduct and the attitudes surrounding sexuality within the family.

I cannot independently verify every detail of that story, and I do not claim that either recollection, on its own, establishes misconduct. Nor do I claim to know another person's private intentions merely from a conversation or an account passed on by someone else.

What I can say is that these memories contributed to my questions about the private and public dimensions of Bruce's position in the family.

I perceived a contrast between his public standing as a wealthy, influential family patriarch and aspects of private conduct that I found difficult to interpret. Over time, I became increasingly concerned about the possibility that some matters were treated differently depending on who was involved and whose reputation might be affected.

Those concerns are part of my testimony, but they must remain distinguishable from independently established findings.

The reason I preserve these details is not to claim that an ambiguous conversation proves a particular conclusion. It is to record what I remember, why it concerned me, and how it fits into the wider history of relationships, sexuality, loyalty, and unequal power that I am trying to document.

11. When Family Power Became a Question of Survival

As I look back, the central question about Bruce is not simply whether he had money or whether he was generous to other relatives.

It is what the availability of resources meant when I was trying to escape hardship and rebuild my independence.

I believed Bruce had the means to help me in a substantial way. I believed he understood, or could have taken steps to understand, the seriousness of the circumstances I was describing. I wanted financial assistance that would enable me to

secure stability, rebuild my NDIS business, and move away from the conditions I experienced as damaging.

I felt that he had the capacity to help but did not provide the assistance I was seeking.

I also came to believe that his position within the extended family influenced the way my circumstances were interpreted by other people. I suspected that the social and financial relationships surrounding the family made it difficult for me to challenge the treatment I experienced without risking further isolation.

I cannot establish from these impressions alone that Bruce coordinated with other people to harm me or that every subsequent difficulty was connected to him. Those are conclusions that would require specific evidence, and I want readers to distinguish the documentary record from my interpretation of it.

But the personal significance is unmistakable.

I was asking for help while I felt that my life was becoming increasingly unstable. I wanted the chance to recover, to work, to live safely, and to regain control over my future.

I did not experience the response I needed.

That failure, as I experienced it, became part of a broader loss of trust in my family.

The people who had taught me the importance of loyalty were not, in my experience, providing the practical support I believed that loyalty should entail.

The people whose resources appeared capable of making a meaningful difference did not provide the outcome I was seeking.

And the longer I remained in hardship, the more difficult it became to separate my personal circumstances from my questions about family influence, community standing, and the institutional decisions affecting my life.

Here is Part 2, continuing from Part 1 without restarting the document. This section covers the extended family's employment and financial relationships, your sister's public advocacy, your father's circumstances, the HCF claim, the Christmas gifts, homelessness, Crystal, and the growing breakdown of family trust.

THE ENEMY WITHIN

PART TWO — FAMILY WEALTH, UNEQUAL SUPPORT, AND THE CHRISTMASES OF EXILE

12. The Extended Family Network: Employment, Opportunity, and Unequal Support

To understand why I came to feel so isolated within my own family, it is necessary to examine the broader network of relationships, employment opportunities, financial assistance, and social connections that surrounded us.

My recollection is that Bruce occupied a position of considerable influence within the extended family. He had substantial financial resources, property interests, and connections that appeared to create opportunities for other relatives. I understood members of the family to have benefited from employment, business relationships, financial assistance, and other forms of practical support.

I remember that Bruce employed my cousin Carolyn's husband, Scot. I also remember Bruce supporting my aunt's son Paul and other members of the extended family. My understanding was that various relatives had access to opportunities that could provide income, security, and a degree of independence.

I do not suggest that relatives were wrong simply because they received assistance. Employment and financial support can be entirely legitimate expressions of generosity. My concern is the contrast between the assistance I understood to be available within the family and the help I was unable to obtain when I believed I urgently needed it.

I was not asking for my relatives to lose their opportunities. I was asking why there did not appear to be a comparable effort to help me recover my own independence.

I wanted practical assistance that would enable me to escape the circumstances I experienced as damaging, obtain stability, and rebuild my working life. I wanted my circumstances to be assessed on their merits rather than reduced to a question of whether I had worked hard enough.

The contrast became more difficult to bear as my circumstances deteriorated. I was trying to manage financial hardship, the consequences of injury, and disputes that I believed required proper investigation. I felt increasingly separated from the family network that seemed capable of offering others assistance.

Over time, I came to question whether loyalty within the family operated equally for everyone. I wondered whether some people were afforded protection and opportunity while I was expected to endure hardship without comparable support.

I cannot establish that there was a deliberate arrangement to distribute resources against me. I cannot infer the motives of every relative from the fact that they received help. But I can record the disparity as I experienced it and ask that the relevant relationships and decisions be considered in their proper context.

For me, this was not merely a question of money. It was a question of belonging, dignity, and whether the family principles I had been taught would be applied when I was the person in need.

13. Scot, the West Gate Bridge, and a Memory I Have Struggled to Understand

There is another personal recollection involving Scot that forms part of my account of the extended family.

I remember an encounter beneath the West Gate Bridge that I understood to have a sexual dimension. I also remember feeling that I was treated differently after I spoke about the experience.

The memory has remained significant to me because of the circumstances surrounding it and the difficulty I experienced in making sense of the relationships involved. I wondered whether speaking about the encounter had changed how other people perceived me or affected the way I was treated.

I cannot independently establish that the encounter caused any subsequent treatment, nor can I prove that anyone coordinated a response to what I said. Those are matters that would require corroborating evidence, contemporaneous communications, or other reliable records.

I nevertheless include this recollection because it is part of the personal history through which I came to understand the vulnerability I felt within the family network.

I was already uncertain about my sexuality and concerned about being judged. I had memories of derogatory language being used against me, and I had experienced circumstances in which I feared that private matters could become sources of gossip or humiliation.

Against that background, any encounter that complicated my relationships with relatives or people connected to the family could have significant emotional consequences.

I wanted to be able to speak about my experiences without automatically fearing that doing so would make me a target of further ridicule, rejection, or exclusion.

I wanted people to consider what I was saying rather than simply decide what kind of person they believed me to be.

This recollection belongs in the documentary record because it helps explain my concerns about sexuality, family relationships, and the unequal power I felt existed between myself and people who appeared to have stronger social or financial positions.

It does not, by itself, establish a coordinated campaign or prove the motives of anyone involved. I want the distinction preserved. My experience can be recorded honestly without turning every unresolved question into a finding of fact.

14. My Sister Jodie: Public Advocacy and My Private Experience of Homelessness

My sister Jodie occupies a particularly painful place in this history because of the contrast I perceived between her public advocacy and my own circumstances.

I remember Jodie holding high-ranking management positions and publicly advocating for justice and people experiencing homelessness. I recall her participating in public-facing activities, including camping out and posting about homelessness and social issues on LinkedIn.

Those activities presented a public commitment to recognising the difficulties faced by vulnerable people.

At the same time, I was experiencing homelessness myself. I was living in my car during periods of severe hardship, trying to navigate financial problems and unresolved disputes while struggling to obtain the assistance I believed I needed.

I found the contrast deeply difficult to reconcile.

I understood that public advocacy did not mean Jodie was personally responsible for solving every problem faced by every person in her family. I also cannot know every private consideration that influenced her decisions or what she believed she was able to do.

But I was not asking for an abstract promise that homelessness mattered. I was living through it.

I wanted the people closest to me to recognise that the person sleeping in a car was not an anonymous statistic or a hypothetical example. It was their own family member.

I wanted someone to ask what had happened, what help I needed, and whether practical intervention could prevent my circumstances from deteriorating further.

I wanted my situation to receive the same seriousness that public discussions about homelessness demanded for people outside the family.

Instead, I experienced a painful distance between the public language of compassion and the assistance I felt I was receiving privately.

That experience affected my trust. I began to question how family members could advocate for vulnerable people in public while I continued to feel abandoned in my own circumstances.

I do not present that contradiction as proof that Jodie acted with malicious intent. I present it as an account of how the contrast affected me and why I came to experience the family's response as profoundly inadequate.

For me, compassion could not be measured solely by public statements or professional standing. It also had to be measured by what happened when someone close to us was in trouble and needed practical help.

15. My Father's Cancer, My Parents' Pension, and Bruce's Offer of Factory Work

My father's cancer and my parents' financial circumstances are important parts of this account.

I remember that my parents lived on a pension and that my father was dealing with cancer. These were real constraints on their circumstances, and I do not want to ignore them or suggest that they possessed resources they did not have.

I also remember Bruce offering my father work at Ashley's factory, involving picking and packing.

That offer may have provided a practical source of income. I do not deny that employment can be a legitimate form of assistance, and I cannot establish that the offer was made for any improper reason.

However, the wider circumstances have led me to consider the possible influence of

financial dependence within a family.

When a person relies on another relative for employment or financial support, the relationship can become complicated. A person may feel grateful, obligated, or reluctant to challenge the person providing the assistance. That is a general possibility, not proof that my father was silenced or that Bruce controlled his decisions.

I cannot know precisely what my father thought, what he discussed privately with Bruce, or whether financial dependence affected his willingness to intervene in my circumstances.

But I have repeatedly wondered whether the relationships surrounding our family made it harder for people to question the treatment I believed I was experiencing.

I wanted my father to understand that I was struggling. I wanted him to recognise the seriousness of my circumstances and to help me find a way forward.

I also wanted to believe that our relationship could withstand difficult questions about the family, its expectations, and the way I felt I had been treated.

Instead, I experienced a growing distance between us. I felt that the family structure and its expectations were more powerful than my attempts to explain my circumstances.

The fact that my father had cancer and my parents lived on a pension is part of the context. It may help explain why their own choices were constrained. It does not erase the impact of my experience, but it reminds me that the question of responsibility must be considered carefully rather than answered through assumptions about motives.

I am recording these circumstances because I want the whole history preserved, including details that complicate the narrative rather than simply supporting one interpretation.

16. Ashley, Hayden, Business Opportunities, and the Response That Stayed With Me

I also remember Ashley and Hayden having access to business opportunities or support that I did not feel was available to me.

My concern is not that they should not have been able to work, build businesses, or receive assistance. My concern is that, while I was struggling to maintain my independence, I felt unable to obtain the practical support that might have enabled me

to rebuild my own working life.

I had been involved in the NDIS sector and wanted to re-establish my business. I believed that my circumstances could improve if I received meaningful assistance, understood the options available to me, and had a reasonable opportunity to recover from the difficulties I was experiencing.

Instead, I increasingly felt that my efforts to explain the seriousness of my situation were being dismissed.

One exchange with Ashley has remained particularly painful.

I remember telling Ashley that, without intervention, I feared I would end up as a homeless person preaching on the streets. I was attempting to convey how desperate and unstable my circumstances felt.

I recall Ashley responding with words to the effect of:

"And what a great manic street preacher you will be."

I experienced that response as humiliating.

I was not describing a future I wanted. I was expressing fear about where my life was heading if I could not obtain help. I wanted someone to understand that I was struggling and that I needed a practical response.

The remark, as I remember it, made me feel that my distress had become something to laugh at rather than something to take seriously.

I recognise that I am recounting a conversation from memory and that the precise wording should be understood accordingly. I cannot establish what Ashley intended or whether Ashley understood the seriousness of what I was saying.

I can describe the impact on me.

I felt dismissed at a time when I was asking for help. I felt that the prospect of homelessness and mental distress was being treated as a joke. I felt that I had not been heard.

That experience reinforced my concern about the difference between having opportunities and being able to access meaningful assistance when those opportunities

are needed.

It also affected my confidence in approaching family members for help. Each time I felt dismissed, it became harder to believe that explaining my circumstances would lead to a constructive response.

17. Carolyn, the HCF Income Assistance Claim, and the Need for a Proper Review

My cousin Carolyn helped me with paperwork relating to an HCF income assistance claim.

I want to acknowledge that assistance. Helping someone with paperwork can be useful, particularly when they are already dealing with complicated circumstances.

However, I recall that when the insurer indicated it would not pay without a good reason, Carolyn's response was that I had to accept the decision.

I did not believe that the decision necessarily represented the end of the matter.

I believed I had a legitimate claim under the relevant insurance arrangements and that the decision deserved proper examination. I wanted to understand the basis for the insurer's position, what evidence had been considered, and whether there were avenues for review or challenge.

I was already under financial pressure. I did not have unlimited resources to obtain professional assistance, and I was dealing with other difficulties that made it harder to pursue every avenue.

What I needed was not simply reassurance that an insurer had made a decision. I needed help understanding whether that decision was justified and what I could do if I disagreed with it.

I experienced Carolyn's response as a point at which further examination seemed to stop.

I cannot conclude from that exchange that Carolyn intended to harm me or that the insurer acted unlawfully. Nor can I establish the validity of the claim simply from my belief that it was legitimate. Those questions depend on the policy, the evidence, the insurer's reasons, and any applicable review process.

But I can explain why the response was disappointing.

I wanted someone to help me look at the decision critically. I wanted assistance identifying the relevant documents, understanding the reasons given, and determining whether there was a reasonable basis to challenge the outcome.

I did not feel that I had the resources or support needed to pursue those questions adequately.

That mattered because my financial security was already under pressure. An income assistance claim was not an abstract dispute. It was connected to my ability to meet living expenses and maintain some independence while dealing with other problems.

I came to feel that I was repeatedly left to manage complicated decisions without the legal, financial, or personal support that might have made a difference.

18. The Christmas Cheques: Ten Thousand Dollars Each and the Meaning of Financial Generosity

I remember Bruce giving my aunt Joy, my aunt Lorraine, and my mother $10,000 each at Christmas.

I remember the gifts as conspicuous demonstrations of his financial capacity. They were significant sums, and the occasions made a lasting impression on me.

I do not claim to know every motive behind those gifts. They may have been intended as generosity, financial assistance, or a family Christmas tradition. It would be wrong to assume that the gifts prove an improper intention.

What made them significant to me was the contrast with my own circumstances.

I was struggling and asking for help. I wanted the opportunity to regain stability, rebuild my working life, and escape the conditions I experienced as damaging. I believed that practical financial assistance could have made a substantial difference.

Against that background, the Christmas gifts became a symbol of the resources that existed within the family and the unevenness of the support I felt I received.

Money can mean far more than comfort or status. It can provide a secure place to live, access to legal advice, transport, safety, medical support, and time to recover from a crisis. It can help someone avoid homelessness and regain the capacity to work.

I was not asking to become wealthy simply because another relative was wealthy. I was asking for assistance at a time when I believed I needed it to survive and rebuild.

That is why I found the contrast so difficult to accept.

I could see that substantial financial gifts were possible within the family, yet I did not experience comparable assistance when I was asking for help.

The significance is not that Joy, Lorraine, or my mother did anything wrong by receiving money. I am not suggesting that a gift to one person automatically creates a legal or moral obligation to give the same amount to another.

The question is what those gifts represented in the wider circumstances: the capacity for financial assistance, the relationships through which that assistance was distributed, and the contrast between generosity in some parts of the family and my experience of being left without the help I believed I needed.

For me, the issue became one of fairness and belonging.

I wanted to feel that I mattered enough for my circumstances to be examined seriously. I wanted to know that family loyalty meant something practical when I was in difficulty.

Instead, I increasingly felt that I was on the outside of a network in which resources and opportunities circulated while my own requests for help remained unresolved.

19. The Christmases of Exile: When the Family Gathered and I Was Alone

The later Christmases became some of the most painful periods in my recollection.

By then, I was dealing with serious hardship. I have described periods of homelessness, living in my car, and squatting. I was also trying to navigate disputes concerning income, compensation, legal assistance, and the circumstances that I believed had contributed to my decline in stability.

While relatives gathered for Christmas, I often felt that I had been left outside the family life that was continuing around me.

I understood that extended family members would gather at Bruce's home. There were family relationships, traditions, conversations, and celebrations that continued despite my circumstances.

I remember feeling that I had become an absent person within a family that was still functioning socially.

That was a painful experience because I had not stopped wanting to belong. I had not stopped hoping that my parents and relatives would understand what I was going through. I had not stopped wishing that the people closest to me would recognise how serious my situation had become.

I wanted to be included. I wanted to feel that I had a place at the family table. I wanted to be able to speak honestly about my circumstances without feeling that doing so would result in ridicule, dismissal, or further isolation.

Instead, I remember periods of spending Christmas alone while relatives gathered elsewhere.

The contrast between their gatherings and my circumstances became a symbol of the distance I felt had developed between us.

I could not understand how a family that placed such importance on loyalty and belonging could continue its celebrations while I was struggling to secure the basic stability that I believed I needed.

I recognise that family members may have had their own concerns, limitations, or interpretations of events. I cannot know everything they discussed privately or establish that each person deliberately intended to exclude me.

But I can describe the result as I experienced it.

I was alone. I felt abandoned. I felt that the family relationships I had once trusted were no longer providing the support I had expected from them.

The Christmases became a recurring reminder of that loss.

20. My Parents' Visits: Politeness, Distance, and the Appearance of Normality

During some of these periods, my parents would visit briefly.

I remember those visits as polite and outwardly pleasant. There could be smiles, ordinary conversation, and an appearance of normal family interaction.

But I experienced a painful distance between that appearance and the circumstances in

which I was living.

I was dealing with homelessness or unstable accommodation, financial insecurity, and unresolved matters that I believed had profoundly affected my life. I wanted those circumstances to be recognised and addressed.

I did not want a brief visit to become a substitute for a serious conversation about what had happened or what could be done to help.

I wanted my parents to understand the difference between seeing that I was still alive and recognising the conditions under which I was trying to survive.

I wanted them to ask what practical support I needed. I wanted them to take the time to understand the disputes and difficulties I was trying to explain. I wanted to feel that my circumstances mattered enough for the family to consider whether its response had been adequate.

Instead, I often left those encounters feeling that ordinary politeness had concealed rather than resolved the distance between us.

I experienced the visits as emotionally limited. I felt that the family could maintain the appearance of normality without confronting the depth of my hardship.

I came to question whether my parents understood how isolated I felt, whether they believed they could help, and whether they were willing to challenge the wider family relationships that I had come to regard with concern.

I cannot establish that their smiles were deliberately deceptive or that they intended to maintain a false appearance. Those are interpretations of motive that I cannot prove from the visits alone.

But I can say that I experienced the gap between outward friendliness and practical support as deeply painful.

I wanted more than civility.

I wanted understanding, honest conversation, and meaningful assistance.

I wanted to believe that my parents would stand beside me even if doing so required them to reconsider the family narrative or acknowledge that I had been hurt.

21. Loyalty, Coercive Dependence, and the Moment I Began to Question My Family's Expectations

For much of my life, I believed that loyalty to family was a fundamental obligation.

I was taught that relatives should stand together, that family bonds mattered, and that disagreements should not erase the responsibilities people had towards one another.

I held on to that belief for a long time.

Even when I felt isolated, I continued to hope that my parents would eventually understand. Even when I was disappointed, I wanted to believe that the family relationships could be repaired. Even when I felt dismissed, I kept trying to explain myself.

Over time, however, I began to question whether loyalty was being applied equally.

I wondered why I was expected to preserve family bonds while my own need for support seemed to remain unresolved. I wondered whether my reluctance to abandon the family had made it easier for me to accept circumstances that I should have challenged.

I began to consider whether loyalty can become harmful when it requires a person to remain silent about experiences that are damaging them.

I also began to question the role of financial dependence. When a person lacks money, stable accommodation, legal assistance, or independent support, the practical ability to challenge those around them becomes more limited.

A person may continue to seek help from relatives even after trust has deteriorated because they have few alternatives. They may remain emotionally invested in relationships that repeatedly disappoint them because they still hope those relationships can be repaired.

I experienced something of that conflict.

I wanted to be independent, but I needed resources to rebuild my life. I wanted to challenge decisions I believed were unfair, but I lacked the means to pursue every avenue. I wanted to speak openly about my experiences, but I feared further isolation and the possibility that people would interpret my distress as evidence against my credibility.

I came to believe that my loyalty had left me vulnerable to a form of dependence in which I continued to hope for help from people whose responses had repeatedly disappointed me.

I have used the language of coercive control and narcissistic abuse to describe how I came to understand aspects of these relationships. Those are serious characterisations, and I recognise that the label alone does not establish that a particular person engaged in legally defined coercive control or had a particular psychological condition.

What I can document is the pattern as I experienced it: requests for assistance, disappointment, increasing isolation, unresolved financial difficulties, and a continuing hope that family loyalty would eventually produce a different outcome.

I want that pattern examined through the actual events and evidence rather than dismissed because it concerns family relationships.

22. When Public Reputation and Private Responsibility Seemed to Diverge

Across these experiences, I became increasingly conscious of the difference between public reputation and private responsibility.

My grandfather was remembered as a popular and mischievous man. My father was recognised for decades of service to baseball. Bruce had wealth, property, and a prominent place within the extended family. My sister had publicly advocated for people experiencing homelessness.

Each of these facts formed part of the public or social identities of people who mattered in my life.

My own experience was different.

I remember being a young person uncertain about my sexuality, feeling isolated, and worrying about the judgement of people connected to my family. I remember later periods of financial hardship, unstable accommodation, hospitalisation, and attempts to obtain assistance. I remember Christmases when I felt excluded from family life while relatives gathered together.

The contrast led me to question whether the qualities celebrated publicly were being reflected in the relationships where I most needed them.

I wanted the values of loyalty, compassion, service, and family responsibility to operate in practice.

I wanted to see concern translated into action.

I wanted my circumstances to be considered fairly rather than reduced to assumptions about my character or effort.

I cannot conclude that a person's public reputation proves that they acted improperly in private. Nor can I infer a person's motives simply because I felt unsupported.

But public reputation does not automatically answer questions about private conduct, either.

A person can be widely respected and still have a family member who experiences the relationship as painful or inadequate. A family can maintain traditions and public standing while unresolved conflicts remain within it. A person can advocate for vulnerable people while another person close to them feels unseen.

Those possibilities should be open to examination without automatically condemning anyone or automatically dismissing the person who reports harm.

That is the standard I want applied to my own account.

23. The Cost of Exile: What I Needed and What I Experienced Instead

By the time my circumstances had deteriorated into homelessness and prolonged financial insecurity, I was no longer asking only for emotional understanding.

I needed practical help.

I needed somewhere safe to live. I needed to understand my legal and financial options. I needed assistance navigating disputes that I believed had affected my income and independence. I needed the opportunity to recover from injury and rebuild my working life.

I wanted the family to understand that the situation had become serious and that simple encouragement to work harder was not an adequate response to every difficulty I was facing.

I believed that help could have made a material difference. Financial assistance might

have provided time to obtain advice, stabilise my accommodation, or re-establish my business. Practical support might have helped me navigate processes that were difficult to manage alone.

I did not experience the kind of sustained support I was seeking.

That absence became especially painful because I believed there were resources and relationships within the extended family that could have helped. I saw evidence of employment opportunities, financial gifts, property, and other forms of support directed towards relatives.

I could not understand why the circumstances I was describing did not lead to a comparable effort to help me.

I recognise that resources are not unlimited, that family members have different obligations, and that assistance cannot always be provided in the form requested. I also recognise that my account of the family's resources and decisions must be assessed against reliable evidence.

But those qualifications do not erase the personal reality that I was struggling and felt increasingly alone.

The loss was not only financial. It was the loss of confidence that the people closest to me would respond when I needed them.

It was the experience of continuing to hope for understanding while becoming less certain that understanding would ever come.

It was the feeling of being part of a family in name while being separated from the practical support and sense of belonging that family was supposed to provide.

That is why I describe these years as a period of exile. The word expresses how I experienced my separation from family life, stable housing, and the social world in which I had once hoped to belong.

It is my description of the experience, not a claim that every relative consciously agreed to exile me.

24. The Documentary Record and the Questions That Remain

I do not want this account to rest solely on memory, emotion, or interpretation.

Where documents exist, they should be preserved. Where decisions were made, the reasons should be examined. Where financial assistance was provided, the relevant circumstances should be understood. Where I sought help and was refused, the correspondence and applicable processes should be considered.

The important questions include:

- **What assistance was available within the family, and what assistance did I request?**
- **What did I tell relatives about my circumstances, and what responses did I receive?**
- **What records exist concerning my work, injury, income assistance, insurance, and compensation matters?**
- **What do the contemporaneous records establish about the events I remember from my youth?**
- **What can be corroborated independently, and what remains my recollection?**
- **Which conclusions are supported by documentary evidence, and which require further investigation?**
- **What explanations did the relevant people or organisations provide for their decisions?**
- **Were there opportunities for review, assistance, or intervention that I was unable to pursue because of my financial circumstances?**

These are questions that can be examined without assuming in advance that every suspicion is correct.

They also cannot be answered adequately by dismissing my account simply because it describes painful family relationships or because I have struggled to communicate the full significance of the experiences.

My recollections are part of the record. Documents may confirm some details, complicate others, or reveal gaps that need further investigation. The responsible approach is to preserve the material and distinguish clearly between what is established, what is remembered, and what remains unresolved.

I want readers to be able to undertake that examination for themselves.

The purpose of this document is not to replace evidence with accusation. It is to provide the context necessary to understand why particular events mattered to me, why trust deteriorated, and why I believe the relationships between family power, social reputation, financial support, and my later hardship deserve careful scrutiny.

THE ENEMY WITHIN

PART THREE — HOMELESSNESS, INSTITUTIONAL EXCLUSION, AND THE FINAL TESTIMONY

25. Crystal: The Companion Who Remained With Me Through Exile

Crystal, my dog, occupies a special place in this history.

During periods when I was homeless and living in my car, Crystal was not simply a pet. She was my companion through circumstances in which I often felt that I had lost the support of the people who should have been closest to me.

When a person is homeless, ordinary routines and relationships can disappear. There may be no secure home to return to, no dependable place to rest, and no certainty about what the next day will bring. In those circumstances, the companionship of an animal can provide continuity, comfort, and a reason to keep going.

That was important to me.

Crystal was part of my life when I was struggling with isolation, financial insecurity, and the consequences of experiences I believed had damaged my ability to live independently. My responsibility for her remained important even when I was finding it difficult to secure my own accommodation.

I remember that, during one of my hospitalisations, Bruce paid for accommodation or care for Crystal. I believe this occurred when I had been admitted to hospital around what I remember as my tenth hospital admission.

I was grateful that Crystal had somewhere safe to stay. I did not want her to suffer because I was unwell or unable to care for her temporarily.

But the circumstances became painful when I left hospital and experienced difficulty being reunited with her.

I felt that arrangements had been made for Crystal's care without adequately resolving my own circumstances or ensuring that we could be reunited in a way that was safe and workable.

I cannot establish Bruce's intentions from the fact that he paid for Crystal's care. I cannot say, without evidence, that he intended to separate us or that the arrangements

were made to punish me. The relevant details would need to be assessed against any communications, accommodation records, or other evidence that may exist.

What I can explain is why the experience affected me so profoundly.

Crystal had received accommodation while I remained homeless.

I wanted both of us to be safe. I wanted to recover from hospitalisation without losing the companionship that had helped me endure my circumstances. I wanted a practical plan that addressed the needs of the person and the animal together.

For me, the situation came to represent a painful contradiction: help had been made available for Crystal, but I did not experience an equivalent resolution of my own housing crisis.

I remember thinking, in effect, that the dog had been accommodated while the owner remained in the car.

That was not a criticism of Crystal receiving care. She deserved care. My concern was that our welfare should not have been treated as though one could be addressed while the other remained unresolved.

I needed a path back to stability, not simply a temporary arrangement that left the central problem of my homelessness unanswered.

Crystal's place in this story is therefore inseparable from my wider experience of family support. Her care represented a real act of assistance, but the difficulty I experienced afterwards left me questioning why that assistance had not translated into a more comprehensive effort to address the circumstances affecting us both.

26. Repeated Hospitalisations and the Accumulation of Hardship

My account includes repeated hospitalisations over a period of years. I have described approximately fourteen hospitalisations across two states over four years, and I remember the admission associated with Crystal's accommodation as occurring around my tenth hospitalisation.

The precise number, dates, reasons for admission, and sequence should be verified against hospital records. I do not want a remembered count to be mistaken for a formally reconciled medical chronology.

The significance of these experiences lies in the cumulative circumstances in which they occurred.

I was dealing with substantial distress, unstable accommodation, financial problems, and unresolved disputes. I felt that I was trying to navigate these difficulties without dependable family support or adequate access to the professional assistance I believed I needed.

Repeated hospitalisation can interrupt a person's ability to maintain work, accommodation, relationships, and ordinary routines. When a person is already financially insecure, each disruption can create additional practical problems.

For me, the difficulties did not occur in isolation. I was trying to manage my health and wellbeing while also attempting to understand decisions affecting my income, legal position, and future independence.

I felt that the broader circumstances contributing to my distress were not always being addressed in the way I believed they should be. I wanted the events leading to my difficulties to be examined, not simply the fact that I was experiencing distress.

I also wanted people to understand that being hospitalised did not make my account of other events automatically unreliable. A person's health history does not, by itself, determine whether their recollections or documentary evidence are accurate. Specific claims still require assessment, but they should be assessed on their merits.

I have sought to document my experiences because I want the underlying records preserved. Hospital admission records, clinical notes, discharge summaries, correspondence, and other contemporaneous documents may help establish dates, the reasons recorded for admission, and the circumstances known to the people involved.

Where I have described an initial assessment as identifying adjustment disorder rather than psychosis or delusion, that distinction should be checked against the original clinical documentation. I want the actual wording of the records to speak for itself, rather than have my account depend on an imprecise recollection or a later interpretation.

My purpose is to preserve the evidence and make it possible to examine how my health, housing, and other circumstances interacted over time.

27. Homelessness: The Difference Between Being Alive and Being Safe

Living in a car was not simply an inconvenience. It affected my privacy, security, ability to rest, and capacity to plan for the future.

A car can provide temporary shelter, but it is not a substitute for stable accommodation. It does not provide the same security as a home, and it can make everyday tasks more difficult. There is the constant question of where to park, how to maintain hygiene, how to manage possessions, and how to avoid further instability.

My circumstances were particularly difficult because I was also trying to care for Crystal and navigate other unresolved matters.

I wanted a secure place to live. I wanted to regain independence. I wanted to rebuild my working life and have enough stability to pursue the matters I believed required investigation.

Instead, I often felt that I was operating in survival mode.

The energy that could have gone into recovery, work, and constructive planning was consumed by immediate concerns about accommodation, money, and what would happen next.

I also experienced homelessness as a loss of social standing and dignity. It was difficult to reconcile the circumstances in which I found myself with the history of work, education, and professional activity that I had previously built.

I had completed a PhD at Victoria University in 2020, with a thesis titled *A Splice of My Life*. I had written *Recovered, Not Cured: A Journey Through Schizophrenia*, published by Allen & Unwin. I have described receiving recognition associated with that work, including a Human Rights Award and SANE Australia's Book of the Year recognition. The relevant awards and publication details should be checked against the original records wherever they are cited publicly.

Those achievements formed part of my professional history. They did not make me immune to hardship, and they did not guarantee that I would be able to obtain help when my circumstances deteriorated.

I found the contrast difficult to bear.

I had a history of education, writing, and public work, yet I was experiencing periods of homelessness and struggling to secure the support I believed I needed.

I felt that my previous achievements and the evidence I was trying to preserve were not translating into practical assistance or recognition of the circumstances I was describing.

I do not believe that a person's education or professional achievements automatically establish the correctness of every claim they make. But neither should a person's homelessness or distress be used as a reason to avoid examining their evidence.

The proper question is what the records establish, what decisions were made, and whether the relevant responses were fair and adequate.

28. The Injury, the Workers' Compensation Claim, and the Loss of Financial Security

My financial hardship was compounded by disputes involving injury and compensation.

I have described an injury connected with my work and circumstances involving exposure to sexual abuse. I pursued workers' compensation because I believed I had legitimate grounds for a claim and that the consequences of the injury should be recognised.

I also believed that the way my employment or work status was classified affected the handling of my circumstances. I have referred to differences between descriptions of my status in correspondence and the classifications used by organisations dealing with compensation matters.

Those differences are important questions for documentary examination. The original letters, claim decisions, employment records, and applicable legal framework would need to be considered together before reaching a conclusion about their significance.

I have estimated the financial consequences of the workers' compensation dispute at more than one million dollars. That figure represents my estimate of the potential loss or detriment, not an amount that should be presented as an adjudicated entitlement unless supported by an authoritative determination.

The consequences I experienced were nevertheless serious.

When income is interrupted or compensation is denied, the effect can extend well beyond the immediate claim. It can affect housing, the ability to obtain advice, the capacity to pay ordinary expenses, and the time available to recover from an injury.

I felt that I was being left to manage the consequences of the dispute without sufficient

legal or financial support.

I wanted the decision-making process to be examined carefully. I wanted to understand how my work had been classified, what evidence had been considered, what reasons had been given, and whether the relevant decisions were consistent with the applicable obligations.

I also wanted a fair opportunity to challenge decisions that I believed had materially affected my life.

The lack of resources made that difficult. Legal disputes can be complex and expensive, and the person seeking review may have to navigate processes involving organisations with far greater resources.

My experience was that financial insecurity and the difficulty obtaining representation compounded one another. I needed advice to pursue the dispute, but the unresolved dispute itself contributed to my inability to obtain and pay for advice.

That is one of the central problems I want readers to understand: a person can become trapped between the need to challenge a decision and the lack of resources needed to challenge it effectively.

I cannot treat my own estimate of losses as a legal finding, and I do not ask readers to do so. I ask them to examine the claim records, decisions, employment-status documents, and other relevant evidence to determine what can properly be established.

29. Legal Assistance, Administrative Decisions, and the Difficulty of Being Heard

My experiences were not limited to the compensation dispute.

I have described difficulties obtaining legal assistance in relation to several matters, including compensation and tribunal proceedings. I have also described problems accessing support while dealing with administrative decisions that I believed required review.

The practical effect was that I often felt unable to pursue every avenue that might have been available to me.

Legal and administrative systems can involve strict deadlines, evidentiary requirements, procedural rules, and decisions about eligibility for assistance. When a person is dealing with homelessness, injury, financial insecurity, and repeated

disruption, managing those processes can become particularly difficult.

I wanted help understanding the options available to me and the steps necessary to pursue them.

I wanted decisions to be explained clearly, records to be preserved, and relevant evidence to be considered.

I wanted my circumstances to be assessed on their merits rather than allowing my lack of resources to become the reason that unresolved questions remained unanswered.

I experienced the lack of legal representation as a major disadvantage. I believed that I needed professional assistance to navigate the processes effectively, but I did not have the financial means to obtain all the help I sought.

I also came to believe that the cumulative effect of the decisions and barriers I encountered was leaving me increasingly isolated from systems that were supposed to provide mechanisms for review, accountability, or assistance.

That is my assessment of the pattern. It should be tested against the individual decisions, reasons, correspondence, eligibility criteria, and review rights rather than treated as a conclusion established merely by the fact that I experienced adverse outcomes.

I want to make the documentary record as clear as possible so that readers can see what I asked for, what responses I received, and what opportunities for review were available.

A refusal is not automatically unlawful. An adverse decision does not, by itself, prove corruption or coordination. But a decision should be capable of being examined against the relevant evidence, legal requirements, and reasons provided.

That is the standard I want applied to the matters affecting my life.

30. Family Relationships and Institutional Decisions: The Questions I Came to Ask

As my circumstances deteriorated, I began to consider whether the family difficulties I experienced and the institutional decisions affecting me were connected.

I came to suspect that relationships, reputations, and decisions across different parts of my life might have interacted in ways that left me disadvantaged.

I also came to believe that my family circumstances were not being examined in isolation from the financial and administrative problems I was facing.

These concerns grew out of the cumulative experience of seeking assistance, encountering decisions I disagreed with, struggling to obtain representation, and feeling that people who might have helped me were unwilling or unable to intervene.

I want to be precise about what this means.

The fact that several people or organisations made decisions that I experienced as adverse does not, by itself, establish that they were coordinating their actions. Nor does the existence of social relationships prove that those relationships influenced a particular decision.

Those conclusions would require evidence of specific communications, actions, agreements, or other relevant circumstances.

But the absence of a proven coordination arrangement does not mean that every decision was necessarily correct or that the cumulative effect of the decisions should not be examined.

My concern is that the overall pattern of my experience deserves assessment, including the reasons provided for individual decisions and whether the available evidence was considered properly.

I have tried to preserve correspondence, official records, decisions, and other material that I believe helps establish the chronology.

I want the records compared rather than considered as unrelated fragments. I want inconsistencies identified, explanations requested where appropriate, and conclusions limited to what the evidence supports.

I also want my own interpretations to remain visible as interpretations. I do not want the account to be rewritten in a way that removes my concerns, but I do not want uncertainty disguised as certainty either.

The purpose of documentation is to allow a reader to distinguish the facts that can be established from the questions that remain open.

31. The Family's Public Life and My Private Circumstances

One of the most painful features of my experience was the contrast between the continuity of family life and the instability of my own circumstances.

The family continued to have its relationships, celebrations, employment arrangements, and public identities. Relatives continued to gather. People continued with their lives.

I, meanwhile, felt that I was losing the stability that would allow me to participate in ordinary life.

I was trying to understand my circumstances, recover from injury, obtain financial assistance, and secure accommodation. I was also trying to preserve my relationships with family members while questioning why the support I needed seemed so difficult to obtain.

The contrast became particularly painful at Christmas.

Those occasions were traditionally associated with belonging, generosity, and family connection. I remember them instead as periods in which I felt acutely aware of my exclusion.

I wanted to believe that the family would eventually recognise the seriousness of my situation. I wanted to believe that my parents would intervene in a meaningful way and that other relatives would be willing to reconsider their understanding of what had happened.

But I continued to feel alone.

I came to experience the family's outward continuity as a painful contrast with my own instability. It seemed to me that family life could continue without addressing the circumstances that had left me homeless or without the support I believed I needed.

I cannot say that every relative understood my situation in the same way, or that every person had the same ability to help. I cannot establish that every absence of assistance was deliberate.

But I can testify that I experienced the overall effect as a profound loss of belonging.

I wanted my family to understand that I was not simply asking for sympathy. I was asking for practical help, fair consideration, and an honest examination of the circumstances that had brought me to that point.

I wanted the people who had taught me the importance of loyalty to recognise that loyalty must also include a willingness to listen, question assumptions, and act when a family member is vulnerable.

32. When I Began to See Loyalty Differently

For a long time, I believed that continuing to seek understanding from my family was an expression of loyalty.

I did not want to abandon the relationships that had shaped my life. I wanted to believe that disagreements could be resolved and that people who had hurt one another could eventually reach a more honest understanding.

I kept hoping that my parents would understand. I kept hoping that the extended family would recognise the seriousness of my circumstances. I kept hoping that the people with resources and influence would see that I needed help rather than simply another judgement about my character.

As the years passed, that hope became harder to sustain.

I began to question whether I was expected to demonstrate loyalty by remaining silent about experiences that I believed had harmed me.

I wondered whether my continued willingness to seek reconciliation had made it easier for others to assume that I would keep accepting disappointment.

I began to understand that loyalty cannot require a person to deny their own experience or pretend that serious problems do not exist.

I also began to recognise that I could continue to care about members of my family while questioning their conduct, decisions, or responses.

That distinction matters to me. I do not need to claim that every relative is wholly good or wholly bad in order to describe experiences that I found painful. I do not need to establish that every person acted with malicious intent in order to explain why I lost trust.

I can acknowledge assistance where it was provided and still explain why I believed it was insufficient.

I can recognise that my parents faced their own health and financial difficulties while still describing the support I needed and did not experience.

I can recognise that other relatives had their own lives and obligations while still asking why the contrast in practical assistance became so pronounced.

I can acknowledge uncertainty about motives while remaining firm about the consequences I experienced.

For me, this is part of reclaiming my own voice. I no longer want family loyalty to require the disappearance of my account.

33. The Difference Between an Allegation, a Recollection, and a Documentary Finding

Because this account concerns family relationships, sexuality, police involvement, financial disputes, and institutional decisions, I want the evidentiary distinctions to remain clear.

There are events I remember personally. There are conversations I recall, sometimes with wording that may need to be checked against contemporaneous notes. There are documents and decisions that may independently establish particular dates, statements, or outcomes. There are also interpretations I have formed about why events occurred and how different circumstances may be connected.

These are not all the same thing.

A recollection is an account of what a person remembers.

A document may establish that a statement was made, a decision was issued, or a request was received, while leaving other questions unresolved.

A conclusion about motive, coordination, or legal responsibility may require additional evidence.

I want my account to preserve all three categories without confusing them.

Where I remember Grandpa calling me a derogatory name and Nana objecting, I can describe that memory directly.

Where I remember my father questioning me about the Volkswagen and South Road, I can describe the exchange as I recall it.

Where I remember the consensual sexual encounter and police involvement, I can state my recollection while acknowledging that records may help establish the exact circumstances.

Where I believe that sexuality-based shame affected how I was treated, I can explain why I reached that interpretation without pretending that I know every person's private thoughts.

Where I believe financial resources were distributed unequally, I can describe the contrast I experienced and identify the records that may clarify the relevant assistance and decisions.

Where I suspect connections between family relationships and institutional outcomes, I can identify the questions and evidence that would be necessary to establish those connections.

This approach does not weaken my testimony. It makes it possible for readers to assess it carefully.

I do not want the account to be dismissed merely because it includes painful interpretations. I also do not want those interpretations to be mistaken for independently established findings where further evidence is needed.

The documentary record should be able to withstand scrutiny. Its purpose is to preserve the material, make contradictions visible, and allow conclusions to be drawn from the evidence rather than from assumptions alone.

34. What I Wanted From My Family

When I look back across the years, the things I wanted were not complicated.

I wanted to be treated with dignity.

I wanted to be able to grow into adulthood without having my sexuality used as a source of humiliation.

I wanted my father to understand why I was isolated rather than simply question where I had been.

I wanted my family to recognise that homelessness and financial insecurity were

serious circumstances requiring practical support.

I wanted help rebuilding my working life after the difficulties I experienced.

I wanted my insurance and compensation concerns to be examined properly.

I wanted assistance navigating legal and administrative processes that I found difficult to manage without representation.

I wanted to be reunited safely with Crystal after hospitalisation.

I wanted my parents to understand that a brief visit could not substitute for a serious conversation about my circumstances.

I wanted family members who had resources and opportunities to consider whether they could help me regain stability.

Most of all, I wanted to feel that I mattered.

I wanted to believe that my place in the family did not depend on whether I was successful, convenient, silent, or able to conceal my distress.

I wanted to know that I could speak honestly about experiences that hurt me without losing the possibility of belonging.

When those expectations were not met, I experienced a gradual loss of trust. The pain did not come from a single event alone. It accumulated through the contrast between what I hoped family loyalty would mean and what I felt happened when I needed it.

I cannot make every person's decision for them, and I cannot know every motive. But I can describe what I needed, what I remember asking for, and how the responses affected me.

That is the testimony I want preserved.

35. The Final Reckoning: What Wealth, Reputation, and Family Loyalty Could Have Done

The central question of this document is not whether my family contained wealthy people, popular people, successful people, or people who had made substantial contributions to their communities.

It is what those advantages meant when I was in need.

My grandfather, Snowy McLean, was remembered as a popular, clever, cheeky, and mischievous man. My father devoted decades to baseball and held a respected place within the local sporting community. Bruce possessed substantial resources and a prominent position within the extended family. Other relatives had access to employment and business opportunities. My sister publicly advocated for people experiencing homelessness.

These details form part of the context in which I experienced my own difficulties.

They do not independently prove that any person acted unlawfully or deliberately sought to harm me. They do, however, help explain why I questioned the difference between public standing and private responsibility.

I remember being a young person who was uncertain about his sexuality and concerned about being judged. I remember Grandpa using a derogatory word against me and Nana asking him to stop. I remember my father's questions about my movements and my experience of spending time alone. I remember the police incident involving sexual activity that I recall as consensual and the fear that it could become a source of community shame.

I remember asking Bruce for help when I was struggling. I remember the response about working harder and creating wealth. I remember financial gifts being made to relatives while I felt unable to obtain the practical support I needed.

I remember my sister's public advocacy for people experiencing homelessness while I was living in my car. I remember the difficulty I experienced pursuing an HCF income assistance claim. I remember the Christmases when I felt excluded from family gatherings and the visits from my parents that seemed polite but did not resolve my circumstances.

I remember Crystal being accommodated while I remained homeless, and the pain of struggling to be reunited with her after hospitalisation.

I remember trying to pursue compensation and obtain legal assistance while financial insecurity made those processes harder to navigate.

I remember continuing to hope that my family would understand, even as my trust deteriorated.

These are the experiences that have shaped my conclusions. They should be examined alongside any available records, correspondence, decisions, and independent evidence. Where my recollection is incomplete, it should be identified as such. Where my interpretation is disputed, the dispute should be recorded. Where documents establish particular facts, those facts should be stated accurately.

I do not seek to replace one unexamined family narrative with another.

I seek an honest examination of the difference between what was publicly celebrated and what I experienced privately; between the language of loyalty and the practical provision of support; between a person's social reputation and the treatment experienced by someone who depends on them for understanding or assistance.

I also want to recognise that the people involved are human beings with their own histories, limitations, and perspectives. Recognising that complexity does not require me to abandon my account or pretend that I was not hurt.

It requires me to speak carefully, preserve what I can substantiate, and remain open to what the evidence reveals.

36. The Meaning of Exile and the Determination to Remain a Witness

I have used the word *exile* because it expresses how I experienced my separation from family life, stable accommodation, and the community in which I once hoped to belong.

For me, exile was not simply a matter of geographical distance. It was the experience of feeling that I could no longer rely on the relationships and structures that had once defined my world.

It was being isolated while people around me continued with their lives.

It was trying to explain my circumstances while feeling that my account was not receiving the consideration I believed it deserved.

It was living through periods of homelessness while hoping that someone would intervene.

It was attempting to pursue financial and legal matters without the resources I believed were necessary.

It was trying to remain connected to my family while questioning whether the loyalty I

had been taught to practise was being reciprocated.

And it was trying to preserve my dignity when I felt that my sexuality, my distress, and my circumstances could be used to diminish my credibility.

I cannot establish that every part of this experience resulted from a single plan or a shared intention among the people involved. My account should not be interpreted as proof of a coordinated arrangement simply because I have experienced a recurring pattern of exclusion.

But I can say that the cumulative effect was profound.

I felt increasingly separated from the people and institutions that I had hoped would provide understanding, protection, or assistance.

I responded by trying to document my experiences. I wanted to preserve the records, establish the chronology, and make it possible for others to examine the material rather than relying entirely on my recollections.

That determination has become part of my identity as a witness.

I do not claim that every conclusion I have drawn is beyond question. I claim the right to preserve the evidence, explain my interpretation, and ask that the material be examined fairly.

37. Faith, Forgiveness, and Divine Justice

My faith has been central to my ability to endure these circumstances.

There were times when I felt abandoned by family, isolated from the community, and unable to obtain the assistance I believed I needed. I struggled with the contrast between the values I had been taught and the circumstances in which I found myself.

I have turned to God for strength, direction, and the capacity to continue.

My faith has helped me distinguish between seeking accountability and seeking revenge. I do not want to become consumed by hatred or to allow painful experiences to determine the person I become.

I want the truth to be examined. I want records preserved. I want decisions assessed fairly. I want people to be able to acknowledge what happened where the evidence

supports that acknowledgement.

But I also recognise that I cannot control every person's response.

I cannot force someone to agree with my interpretation. I cannot determine another person's private motives. I cannot make every institution respond in the way I believe it should.

What I can do is continue to preserve the record, speak carefully about what I remember, distinguish evidence from inference, and ask for a fair examination of the circumstances.

For me, forgiveness does not mean pretending that harm did not occur. It does not mean withdrawing legitimate questions or abandoning the pursuit of accountability.

It means refusing to make revenge the purpose of my life.

I believe that justice and mercy can coexist. I believe that people should have the opportunity to acknowledge mistakes and change. I also believe that a person's dignity should not depend on whether powerful people approve of their account.

My faith has given me a reason to keep going when I have felt that my social position, financial circumstances, and lack of support have left me with very little.

I leave ultimate judgement to God while continuing to do what I can to preserve the evidence and seek a fair hearing.

38. A Final Statement to My Family, My Community, and Anyone Examining This Record

To my family, I want it understood that this document comes from years of trying to make sense of experiences that left me feeling isolated, unsupported, and uncertain about where I belonged.

I wanted to be accepted. I wanted to be understood. I wanted help when I was in difficulty. I wanted the family values I had been taught to mean something when I was the person who needed support.

I did not want to spend my life questioning whether my place in the family depended on silence or whether my circumstances would ever be considered fairly.

To my community, I ask that my history be examined without assuming that a person's

public reputation tells the whole story of their private relationships. Popularity, professional achievement, wealth, and community service are not proof of wrongdoing, but neither do they answer every question about how a person has treated someone close to them.

To anyone examining the documentary record, I ask for careful attention to the difference between the events I remember, the documents that may corroborate them, the interpretations I have formed, and the conclusions that can properly be drawn.

I do not ask for facts to be invented on my behalf. I do not ask for uncertain claims to be treated as established findings. I ask for the available evidence to be preserved, read in context, and assessed without prejudice.

I also ask that my experiences not be dismissed simply because they involve family conflict, sexuality, homelessness, hospitalisation, or disputes with institutions.

Those circumstances do not automatically prove my conclusions, but neither do they make my questions unworthy of examination.

I have tried to explain why particular events mattered, how they affected my sense of belonging, and why I came to question the relationships between family power, public reputation, financial assistance, and the treatment I experienced.

I want the account to remain available for scrutiny. I want corrections made where reliable evidence requires them. I want unresolved questions identified honestly. And I want the people reading it to reach their own conclusions by examining the material rather than accepting a predetermined narrative.

I am still here.

I am still documenting.

I am still trying to understand what happened.

I am still bearing witness.

I will not claim certainty where I do not have it, and I will not abandon my recollections merely because they are uncomfortable for others to hear.

I leave revenge to God. I seek truth, accountability, dignity, and a fair examination of the evidence.

Praise Jesus.

The Final Humiliation: What My Family Must Now Confront

The final measure of character is not the value of a car collection, the grandeur of a mansion, the amount of money distributed at Christmas, the success of a business, the prestige of a professional position, or the number of people willing to defer to a powerful family patriarch. It is what a person does when someone they know is suffering, when assistance is within their means, and when offering that assistance might require them to put compassion before reputation, loyalty before convenience, and truth before appearances.

That is the question my family must now confront.

I have spent years trying to understand how a family capable of displaying such generosity, maintaining such community standing, celebrating such professional success, and speaking publicly about justice could leave one of its own experiencing homelessness, isolation, financial desperation, repeated hospitalisations and a profound sense of abandonment. I remember the family gatherings, the Christmases, the visible distribution of wealth, the opportunities extended to other relatives, and the lives that continued to move forward while mine appeared to be falling apart.

I remember asking for help. I remember the responses that stayed with me. I remember being told, in effect, to work harder and create wealth as others had done, while I was struggling with disability, injury, financial insecurity and circumstances I believed required compassion and proper examination. I remember trying to explain what I had experienced and hoping that, eventually, somebody in my own family would stop, listen and ask whether there was something seriously wrong with the way I had been treated.

I cannot claim to know every person's private thoughts, nor can I establish another person's motives merely from the pain their actions or inaction caused me. But I can describe the consequences. I can document the circumstances in which I found myself. I can identify the assistance I sought, the responses I recall, the records I have preserved and the questions that remain unanswered.

And I can ask why the apparent resources of a family did not translate into the security, protection and practical assistance that I desperately needed.

The humiliation is not mine alone simply because I was the person who became homeless. Homelessness is not a moral failure. Disability is not a disgrace. Being gay is

not a source of shame. Asking for help is not evidence of weakness. And refusing to abandon one's account of painful experiences simply because those experiences are inconvenient to others is not a failure of loyalty.

The deeper humiliation lies in the possibility that a family can preserve its public respectability while a member of that same family experiences circumstances that should have compelled those closest to him to ask difficult questions. It lies in the contrast between generosity that can be displayed publicly and compassion that must be demonstrated privately. It lies in the distance between speaking about justice and responding when justice, dignity and assistance are needed by someone within one's own family.

I once believed that family loyalty meant that, no matter how difficult life became, there would be people who would not allow me to fall beyond the reach of their concern. I believed that the bonds of family meant something more substantial than appearances, financial arrangements, Christmas gatherings or the maintenance of a respectable public image. I believed that, if I endured long enough and explained myself clearly enough, my family would eventually want to understand.

That belief sustained me for a long time. Its collapse has been one of the most painful parts of my life.

I have also had to confront the painful contradiction between the assistance provided for Crystal, my beloved dog, and the unresolved circumstances of my own homelessness and separation from her. I remain grateful for any genuine care given to her. I do not need to deny that assistance in order to explain what it felt like to be the person whose own need for safety, stability and reunion remained so painfully unresolved. To me, the experience crystallised a question I still struggle to answer: how could the welfare of the companion who depended upon me receive attention while the person responsible for her care continued to feel abandoned?

My purpose in writing this is not to demand that my family accept every conclusion I have reached. It is to insist that my experience should not be dismissed merely because acknowledging it might be uncomfortable. I have preserved records and published my account because I believe the circumstances deserve serious, independent examination. Where documents establish facts, those documents should be examined. Where my account records memories, those memories should be understood as testimony. Where I have drawn conclusions about patterns, relationships or institutional conduct, those conclusions should be assessed against the available evidence rather than accepted or rejected solely on the basis of family loyalty.

I do not need to invent a motive to describe an outcome. I do not need to prove what every person privately thought to establish that I experienced profound isolation. And I do not need to pretend that everything was acceptable simply to protect the comfort or reputation of other people.

My family may disagree with my interpretation. They may believe that they did enough, that they were unable to help, that they did not understand, or that events were more complicated than I have described. If so, those explanations can be stated and examined. What should not happen is that my life, my suffering and the documentary record are treated as though they have no significance simply because they challenge a familiar family narrative.

The question is no longer whether I can persuade every relative to agree with me. The question is whether the record I have preserved can be examined honestly, whether the consequences I describe can be acknowledged, and whether people are prepared to distinguish genuine accountability from the preservation of appearances.

I have been the person living with the consequences. I have known the loneliness of being excluded from the ordinary securities that other people take for granted. I have experienced the indignity of needing help and feeling that my need was not understood. I have spent years trying to make sense of events that, to me, raised questions about family responsibility, institutional accountability and the meaning of justice.

Yet I am still here.

I am still writing. I am still preserving documents. I am still asking questions. I am still attempting to distinguish what I know from what I remember, what I believe from what I can establish, and what I have endured from what others may be willing to acknowledge.

I will not measure my worth by the wealth of my relatives, the approval of my community, the willingness of powerful people to assist me, or the reputation that others have managed to maintain. My dignity does not depend upon their permission. My humanity is not diminished by homelessness. My sexuality is not a disgrace. My disability does not cancel my right to be heard. And my determination to preserve my testimony does not disappear because the truth is difficult for others to confront.

If my family wishes to respond, there remains an opportunity to do so with honesty, compassion and evidence. They can explain what they remember, identify what they dispute, acknowledge what they regret, and provide records that may clarify the history. That would mean more than silence, appearances or the assumption that time

alone will erase what happened.

I cannot rewrite the past. I cannot compel anyone to feel remorse. I cannot decide what others will say about me. But I can refuse to allow my own account of my life to be erased by shame, fear or the expectation that family reputation must always take precedence over an individual's dignity.

The final measure of a family is not what it possesses, whom it knows, how successful its members appear, or how convincingly it presents itself to the outside world. It is also what happens when one of its own is vulnerable, when assistance is needed, when difficult questions arise and when doing the right thing may carry a personal cost.

That is the measure against which I have come to examine my own family's conduct. It is not a verdict imposed by a court, nor a claim that every question has already been answered. It is the moral reckoning that my lived experience and the record I have preserved compel me to undertake.

I leave the final judgment to the evidence, to independent examination and, in matters of ultimate justice, to God.

I have tried to endure without surrendering my conscience. I have tried to speak without making revenge my purpose. I have tried to preserve my dignity when I felt that others had ceased to recognise it. And I have continued to believe that truth matters, even when its witness stands alone.

My family may control its own response. It cannot control the meaning my experiences have acquired in my life, nor can it decide that the questions I have raised should never be asked.

I am not asking for revenge. I am asking for truth, accountability, dignity and a fair examination of the evidence. I am asking that the person behind this record be recognised as a human being whose life matters, whose suffering deserves to be heard, and whose testimony should be assessed honestly.

I once hoped that my family would be the place where I would never have to prove that I deserved compassion. I have had to learn how to continue living without the certainty of that protection. My faith has helped me survive that loss.

I leave revenge to God. I seek truth, accountability, dignity, and a fair examination of the evidence.

Praise Jesus.